



Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515

Writing sample

Thank you for contacting me to express your views on the First Amendment and right to protest. I appreciate hearing from you on this important issue.

Fundamentally, I want to ensure that our government works better for everyone and that every American's voice is heard in our democracy. No matter your political affiliation, I respect your First Amendment rights and all that it guarantees: freedoms concerning religion, expression, assembly, and the right to petition. The First Amendment forbids Congress from both promoting one religion over others and also restricting an individual's religious practices. It guarantees freedom of expression by prohibiting Congress from restricting the press or the rights of individuals to speak freely. It also guarantees the right of citizens to assemble peaceably and to petition their government.

As a member of the Congressional Law Enforcement Caucus, I believe that upholding the law also means protecting the right to peacefully protest under the First Amendment, free from violence and intimidation.

Let me be clear — President Trump's deployment of the National Guard and Marines to detain immigrants and Americans exercising their First Amendment right to protest came straight from the Project 2025 playbook. Despite pledging to uphold the Constitution, President Trump has consistently violated the law—and Republicans in Congress are enabling him. Regardless of immigration status, everyone in the U.S. is guaranteed the same basic rights. As your voice in Congress, I'm actively sponsoring and reviewing legislation that can put a stop to the Trump Administration's harmful directives. For more guidance on how to protect yourself and loved ones, please visit the American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU) website [here](#) to know your rights.

Moreover, incitement of violence and intimidation of protected classes undermines Americans' ability to peacefully protest, and it endangers pro-Palestine and pro-Israel demonstrators exercising their First Amendment rights. To protect these rights, we must take action against antisemitism, Islamophobia, and all hate speech that falls outside of what the First Amendment protects.

Thank you, again, for contacting me on this very important issue. Rest assured, I remain committed to looking for ways to defend our First Amendment rights, uphold the right to protest, and hold the Trump Administration accountable. I, alongside my Congressional colleagues from both sides of the aisle, continue to take steps to protect the right to assemble while prioritizing public safety, and defend our Constitution. To keep in touch, I encourage you to sign up for my e-newsletter here and regularly visit my website at <https://strickland.house.gov>, where you can find up-to-date information on my work on behalf of our community.

Sincerely,

Marilyn Strickland
Member of Congress